Water

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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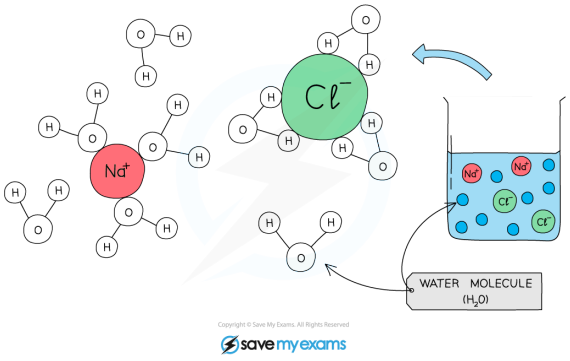
Water as a Solvent

- Water is important for all living organisms as **many substances are able to dissolve in it** (it is a **solvent**)
- This makes it incredibly useful and essential for all life on Earth
- Water is important as a solvent in the following situations within organisms:
  - Dissolved substances can be **easily transported** around organisms - eg xylem and phloem of plants and dissolved food molecules in the blood
  - **Digested food molecules** are in the alimentary canal but need to be **moved to cells** all over the body - without water as a solvent this would not be able to happen
  - Toxic substances such as **urea** and substances in excess of requirements such as **salts** can dissolve in water which makes them easy to **remove from the body in urine**
  - Water is also an important part of the **cytoplasm** and plays a role in ensuring **metabolic reactions can happen** as necessary in cells



Water as a solvent

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